



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 2

ALABAMA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Alabama's family courts and child-welfare system.

48

ALABAMA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 55
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 14 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 3, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

22 OF 67

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ALABAMA AT A GLANCE.

Across 48 Alabama families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 55 45 of 48 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$11,650 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 14 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 41.7% 27.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 48	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.2	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 45 of 48	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 22

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Alabama families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02

THE COST OF ALABAMA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	26	\$11,650	\$24,890	\$647,142
Lost Wages	26	\$23,500	\$280,004	\$7,280,115
Other Court Fees	14	\$1,000	\$6,500	\$91,000
Therapy / Evaluations	17	\$2,000	\$3,818	\$64,900
Reunification Services	11	\$0	\$1,155	\$12,700
GAL Fees	16	\$1,000	\$2,334	\$37,350
Asset Loss ¹	18	\$21,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$60,650	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$21,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		14	1.2 yrs
Mean months lost		43	3.6 yrs
Total across all families		1,123	93.6 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ALABAMA

Most families documenting in Alabama are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		18	38%
Not provided		13	27%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		7	15%
Case closed: within last 2 years		5	10%
Active case: progress being made		2	4%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		18	38%
Family Court Only		15	31%
Unknown		9	19%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		3	6%
Family Court		1	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		17	35%
5 – 10 years		7	15%
3 – 5 years		5	10%
Over 10 years		5	10%
0-1 years		4	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		16	33%
Visitation Only		14	29%
Full Custody		6	12%
50/50 Joint		3	6%
Not Applicable		3	6%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Mobile		3	6%
Houston		3	6%
Baldwin		2	4%
Autauga		2	4%
Talladega		2	4%
Cullman		1	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		11	23%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		9	19%
Other: (Short answer)		7	15%
False Allegations / Coached Claims		5	10%
Other		3	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — ALABAMA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Alabama comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Destroyed my family and my relationship with my children who I practically raised on my own for 14 years. Caused trauma, anxiety, PTSD

— BRANDY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with [...]

— ALABAMA PARENT · JACKIE

MORE VOICES FROM ALABAMA

Threatening me with jail time unless I gave into the ex at court. All because I would not give my children to him during my parenting time. Simply because the parenting coordinator and GAL said I should. The judge wants to set an example. You cannot bring your phone on that [...]

— RACHEL

The family court system fully showed me why the government should have 0 say so or hand in how YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN ARE parented.

— JESSICA

Destroyed our family my son passed and we have not seen our granddaughter since she didn't even get to come to her dad's funeral

— KELLI

Family court has destroyed all consistency and stability for my children. We do not feel safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A system ment to bring families together did nothing but traumatically rip mine apart.

— FELICIA

The system has proven to my children and I that they are not there to provide support, protection and reunification. They very boldly stand in your face and laugh while doing the complete opposite due to financial motives. They have stolen the first two years of my children's [...]

— MARY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They falsely accused me of child abuse and took two of my children. Then I had another one and they took her. DHR ended up giving me back the youngest and are making me go to family court against my Dad and stepmom for my other two. I just recently went back to court for the [...]

— LATOYA

This system has destroyed my family and our belief in justice, hope, and humanity.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took tragedy as an opportunity to create lasting trauma my family and I still have not fully recovered from. We haven't even had a ceremony to grieve our lost son yet because we're still trying to recover from the disaster that destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children have been alienated from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They physically mentally and emotionally abused me and my child and financially took everything from me by my mental stage I have not been able to work since I cannot focus on that when I was focusing trying to figure out why there's taking my child in the first place

— JODIE

Jefferson county has shattered me and left me without a voice all while covering up someone is who abusive and has a criminal record and our children have begged to not go back to him.

— ASHLEE

They've taken children who already lost their parents and put them in dangerous situations when they have a loving grandmother who would give her life to protect and love them.

— STEPHANIE

Left me isolated from every one and mentally debilitated me with phyco report says 60% out of a 100 is my custody n dep issue

— CLOEY

They have ruined my life, making my daughter feel unsafe because we can't be together.

— MEGAN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*ASTNGU. AMTNGU. This bond between us can't be broken, I will be here don't you cry.
You'll be in my Heart. ☐ Always.*

— HEATHER

CPS and family court trafficked my children to the pedophile father and erased me, a safe, protective mother from my daughter's lives. I have a gag order and am not allowed to speak about my case. But I still do however I can.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court allowed my sister-in-law to walk in there and say I was messed up on drugs leaving my two year old defend for herself. I never got served properly. My neighbor found it in her mailbox, but I still had to hand my children over only two of them, though I got to keep the [...]

— CRYSA NY

Took the life of my husband, almost mine and alienated maternal side of the family, unjust actions to terminate my rights. They have taken both of my daughters parents from her.

— HEIDI

Not allowing for me make contact with my daughter, enabling my ex's bad behavior, by allowing her to hide my daughter from me, not telling if she's okay or not, just dead silence

— TERRY

This system has absolutely tore my family apart. I now deal with trauma and will need counseling and I have my baby back but I feel I have to put cameras in every room in my home because of what I've been through with these allegations .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

If you wanted to destroy a powerful woman... you wouldn't go after her directly. You'd go after her heart. Her children. Her sanity. This is family court and it's destroying the heart and soul of our children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has failed my two granddaughters.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Thankfully my family court battle started when my daughter was a baby and her last visit with her father was 2019. But the fear of the Judge and how everything went down was enough to last a lifetime. I hate anyone going through family court. It's so unfair.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

My son suffers from always worrying about DHR coming to get him. They have tried for 14 years to take my son. I told them they wasn't getting mine and that it was harassment after so many visits. I told them it wasn't a crime to be poor as long as my child had his needs met.

— TRACY

It has showed us that no matter how good a person you are, or how right you are, there are people in positions of power who will gleefully make you the scum of the earth in the eyes of the court. It doesn't matter how insane another person is or how many crazy things they do, if [...]

— JASON

I am terrified to let my child out of my site. Every single little mark I am documenting it all. I cptsd and am having to go to therapy for this. I have nightmares of this even after 3 yrs. I have a hard time letting anyone visit us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Some days I sit back and realize... the worst thing that has ever happened in my life barely exists in anyone else's. My child was taken away. My world stopped. My heart broke in a way that will never fully heal. But the world didn't stop. People kept laughing. Kept posting. Kept [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined everything I made.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

31 Alabama parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 31 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ALABAMA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Alabama families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with a second occurrence that happened this past October. Severe poverty, loss, destitution, loss of civil liberties (the government suspended my drivers licence because I couldn't pay outrageous child support- my parents had to drive me to chemotherapy and life-saving medical appointments). My income is long term disability and I get \$2150/month. My court order for child support is over \$600/month. He won't let it go. I'm in arrears of over \$40,000. It's still being tallied up by the month. Any income and credits from GST or other government rebates get garnished and automatically go to him. Severe financial and economic post-separation abuse. Evidence of physical and all other abuse during marriage which I presented to the courts was blatantly ignored & swept under the rug. He remarried and the income between him and his spouse is at least \$350,000/year. They tried to bury me alive and still are. Fraud, maliciousness. Contempt of court. Not providing his tax returns for the last 5 years. In the same week I found out I had survived my first occurrence with breast cancer, the ex threatened me with a mobility application to move my kids cross-country. They gave him everything, I lost everything because I was too weak to represent myself and couldn't afford a lawyer. Legal Aid in my province is filled with incompetence and negligence - nobody would help me. In fact, the lawyers from legal aid took

— JACKIE (1/2)

advantage of my vulnerabilities and purposely dragged me, one for an entire year, she did absolutely nothing but gave me false hope. It's really unbelievable and sadistic. I have literally paid with my life and my kids lives because I made the choice to get married. Alberta Canada is festering with some of the most corrupt judges in the Western world. What happened to me and is still happening is absolutely criminal.

— JACKIE (2/2)

Destroyed my family and my relationship with my children who I practically raised on my own for 14 years. Caused trauma, anxiety, PTSD

— BRANDY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Threatening me with jail time unless I gave into the ex at court. All because I would not give my children to him during my parenting time. Simply because the parenting coordinator and GAL said I should. The judge wants to set an example. You cannot bring your phone on that floor of the court house. 10 years of abuse, 4 years of battling in the courts to keep my children and this is where we are. My sons will end up with a vindictive manipulator and the people who enable him.

— RACHEL

The family court system fully showed me why the government should have 0 say so or hand in how YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN ARE parented.

— JESSICA

Destroyed our family my son passed and we have not seen our granddaughter since she didn't even get to come to her dad's funeral

— KELLI

Family court has destroyed all consistency and stability for my children. We do not feel safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A system ment to bring families together did nothing but traumatically rip mine apart.

— FELICIA

The system has proven to my children and I that they are not there to provide support, protection and reunification. They very boldly stand in your face and laugh while doing the complete opposite due to financial motives. They have stolen the first two years of my children's lives from me.

— MARY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They falsely accused me of child abuse and took two of my children. Then I had another one and they took her. DHR ended up giving me back the youngest and are making me go to family court against my Dad and stepmom for my other two. I just recently went back to court for the other two but they are making me prove something called the McClendon Standard which is only used in Alabama. I wish I could speak on this

— LATOYA

This system has destroyed my family and our belief in justice, hope, and humanity.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took tragedy as an opportunity to create lasting trauma my family and I still have not fully recovered from. We haven't even had a ceremony to grieve our lost son yet because we're still trying to recover from the disaster that destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children have been alienated from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They physically mentally and emotionally abused me and my child and financially took everything from me by my mental stage I have not been able to work since I cannot focus on that when I was focusing trying to figure out why there's taking my child in the first place

— JODIE

Jefferson county has shattered me and left me without a voice all while covering up someone is who abusive and has a criminal record and our children have begged to not go back to him.

— ASHLEE

They've taken children who already lost their parents and put them in dangerous situations when they have a loving grandmother who would give her life to protect and love them.

— STEPHANIE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Left me isolated from every one and mentally debilitated me with phyco report says 60% out of a 100 is my custody n dcp issue

— CLOEY

They have ruined my life, making my daughter feel unsafe because we can't be together.

— MEGAN

ASTNGU. AMTNGU. This bond between us can't be broken, I will be here don't you cry. You'll be in my Heart. ☹ Always.

— HEATHER

CPS and family court trafficked my children to the pedophile father and erased me, a safe, protective mother from my daughter's lives. I have a gag order and am not allowed to speak about my case. But I still do however I can.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court allowed my sister-in-law to walk in there and say I was messed up on drugs leaving my two year old defend for herself. I never got served properly. My neighbor found it in her mailbox, but I still had to hand my children over only two of them, though I got to keep the other two. Until July of 24 and my oldest son got taken because I was stupid and didn't get a lawyer at all. My 13-year-old has never been taken she with me the whole time.. they allowed my sister-in-law to play games with my children when she couldn't handle it she gave them back to me. I got to keep them for a month and then we went back to court. They made me have my kids back over again because they didn't do a drug test on me. Then when I did my drug test the past they still wouldn't give me my kids.

— CRYSANI

Took the life of my husband, almost mine and alienated maternal side of the family, unjust actions to terminate my rights. They have taken both of my daughters parents from her.

— HEIDI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Not allowing for me make contact with my daughter, enabling my ex's bad behavior, by allowing her to hide my daughter from me, not telling if she's okay or not, just dead silence

— TERRY

This system has absolutely tore my family apart. I now deal with trauma and will need counseling and I have my baby back but I feel I have to put cameras in every room in my home because of what I've been through with these allegations .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

If you wanted to destroy a powerful woman... you wouldn't go after her directly. You'd go after her heart. Her children. Her sanity. This is family court and it's destroying the heart and soul of our children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has failed my two granddaughters.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Thankfully my family court battle started when my daughter was a baby and her last visit with her father was 2019. But the fear of the Judge and how everything went down was enough to last a lifetime. I hate anyone going through family court. It's so unfair.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son suffers from always worrying about DHR coming to get him. They have tried for 14 years to take my son. I told them they wasn't getting mine and that it was harassment after so many visits. I told them it wasn't a crime to be poor as long as my child had his needs met.

— TRACY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has showed us that no matter how good a person you are, or how right you are, there are people in positions of power who will gleefully make you the scum of the earth in the eyes of the court. It doesn't matter how insane another person is or how many crazy things they do, if the court is on their side then they're gonna win.

— JASON

I am terrified to let my child out of my site. Every single little mark I am documenting it all. I cptsd and am having to go to therapy for this. I have nightmares of this even after 3 yrs. I have a hard time letting anyone visit us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Some days I sit back and realize... the worst thing that has ever happened in my life barely exists in anyone else's. My child was taken away. My world stopped. My heart broke in a way that will never fully heal. But the world didn't stop. People kept laughing. Kept posting. Kept living like nothing happened. And I don't blame them... but it still hurts. Because for me, it's not a "moment." It's not something I can move past. It's not a memory I can just visit when I feel like it. It's my everyday life. It's waking up missing them. Going to sleep missing them. Hearing their name in my head but not out loud. Living in a world that keeps moving... without them. And sometimes it feels like I'm the only one still standing in the middle of the loss, while everybody else already walked away from it. Like my pain is too big for people to sit with, so they just... don't. But I carry it. Every single day. I carry the love. I carry the memories. I carry the "what ifs." I carry the silence. So if I seem distant, or different, or heavy sometimes... just know— I'm living a life I never asked for, without someone I can never replace. And even if the world moved on... I never will.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined everything I made.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

31 full approved Alabama comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Alabama report comes from Alabama respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Alabama — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 48 Alabama families reporting here are not the universe of Alabama families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

STANDWITHMEG.COM | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.